VOL. I WEEKDAY EDITION

THE ELON GAZETTE

Weekday briefing on what Elon Musk is saying and doing

WEDNESDAY, NOVEMBER 11, 2026

THE MORNING PICTURE

SpaceX orders the solar gear for a "sentient sun"

Elon Musk said Tuesday evening that SpaceX has ordered "100 GW/year" of heterojunction solar-cell manufacturing equipment from Germany's Singulus Technologies, to power the Starmind AI satellites it plans to build in Bastrop, Texas: "This is for Starmind to create a sentient sun." Overnight he cheered Starlink's new battery-powered Mini 2 dish, recalled that SoftBank's Masayoshi Son once put $12 billion into WeWork rather than into a quarter of Tesla, agreed that cheap robotaxi rides will grow total travel, and kept up a running argument with Rust programmers over why C still rules on bare metal.

I · SPACEX & STARLINK

A solar factory for satellites that think

Singulus will deliver its first heterojunction cell line to SpaceX's Bastrop factory in 2027, the start of a partnership sized for more than 100 gigawatts of equipment.

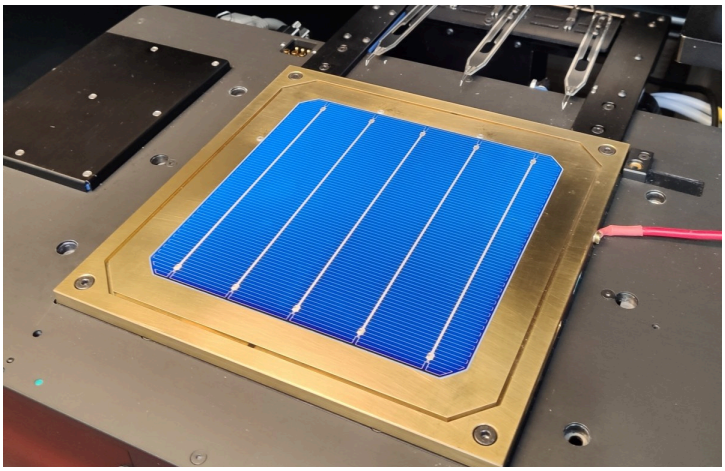
>€60M	H1 2027	100 GW
Order volume of the first production line	Delivery of the first line to Bastrop, Texas	Production equipment the partnership is meant to support

At 2:04 p.m. EST Tuesday SpaceX said it had "signed a major supply contract with SINGULUS to create a durable option for advanced solar cell manufacturing to support more than 100 GW of equipment as we accelerate the production of our Starmind satellites in Bastrop, Texas." Musk quoted the post at 6:47 p.m. EST:

> *"SpaceX has ordered 100 GW/year of HJT solar manufacturing equipment from Singulus in Germany. This is for Starmind to create a sentient sun."*
> ELON MUSK · 6:47 P.M. EST TUESDAY

HJT stands for heterojunction, a cell design that coats a crystalline silicon wafer with thin layers of amorphous silicon to cut energy losses at its surface. In its announcement, Singulus, based in Kahl am Main, said it will supply a turnkey production line, the first of "multiple additional lines" planned under a strategic partnership, with delivery in the first half of 2027. SpaceX provided significant funding to Singulus in March 2026 and again in October as part of a subordinated secured loan, the company said. Its nine-month report on Wednesday put the first line's order volume at more than €60 million.

"Partnering with SINGULUS gives us a high-performance manufacturing path for solar cells for our Starmind satellites at our production facility in Texas," said Mike Nicolls, SpaceX's senior vice president of Starlink.



A silicon heterojunction solar cell under test at the Solar Industrial Research Facility, University of New South Wales, March 2020.
PHOTO: RADIOTREFOIL / WIKIMEDIA COMMONS · CC BY-SA 4.0

What Starmind is

SpaceX's Starmind page describes AI1, an orbital satellite carrying its own AI computers, powered by sunlight in sun-

synchronous orbit, cooled by radiating heat into space and linked by laser to the Starlink constellation. AI1 has a 75-meter (246-foot) wingspan, stands 30 meters tall when deployed and carries a compute payload of up to 250 kilowatts peak and 175 kilowatts average. SpaceX says its Gigasat Factory in Bastrop is meant to build "thousands of AI satellites starting as soon as late 2027."

"Dyson Swarm Speedrun"

Quoting the Singulus post at 12:48 a.m. EST Wednesday, Guillaume Verdon (@beffjezos), the founder of Extropic, wrote: "Dyson Swarm Speedrun any%." A Dyson swarm is a hypothetical cloud of solar collectors orbiting a star to capture its energy. Musk replied at 3:35 a.m.: "Pretty much."

Starlink Mini 2 goes on preorder

At 12:28 p.m. EST Tuesday Starlink introduced Mini 2, "the next-generation portable Starlink," with "up to 4.5 hours of connectivity on a single charge with the quick-swap battery," USB-C power and built-in Wi-Fi, and preorders "open by invitation in the US." Musk quoted it at 3:25 a.m. EST Wednesday: "Portable, lightning-fast Internet that works anywhere on Earth where Starlink is legal!"

The new dish is 23.1 millimeters thick, against 38.5 millimeters for the original Mini, weighs about 3.5 pounds and keeps an IP67 dust- and waterproof rating, The Verge reported. Invitations shared by users on X put the price at $999, including a year of Roam Unlimited service.

II · TESLA & SOFTBANK

"That was dumb": Musk on the $12 billion that went to WeWork

As SoftBank took a $3.7 billion charge on gas turbines it could not use, Musk revisited the Tesla stake he says Masayoshi Son passed up.

$3.7B	13 GW+	55%+
SoftBank's charge for cancelled turbine reservations	Gas turbine capacity SoftBank had reserved, mostly from GE Vernova	Fall in SoftBank's shares since June

At 8:00 p.m. EST Tuesday WSJ Business posted the Journal's story that "Masayoshi Son's SoftBank reserved enough gas turbines to generate the power of six Hoover Dams. It cost the company billions of dollars in losses." Katie Miller (@KatieMiller) shared it with "Taps the sign," and at 3:49 a.m. EST Wednesday Musk replied:

> *"I remember that time when Masa, instead of putting $12B into Tesla for a 1/4 of the company to help me take Tesla private, instead invested the money in WeWork. That was dumb."*
>
> ELON MUSK · 3:49 A.M. EST WEDNESDAY

The $12 billion and one-quarter figures are Musk's account and have not been documented as formal offer terms, Dealroom News noted.

BY THE NUMBERS

$2.85B	Non-refundable advances in SoftBank's turbine charge, per Dealroom
$0.88B	Contract changes and settlements in the same charge, per Dealroom
9.2 GW	SoftBank's planned gas plant in southern Ohio, per Dealroom
$160B	SoftBank market value erased since June, per OfficeChai



SoftBank chief executive Masayoshi Son speaks as President Donald Trump looks on at an "Investing in America" event in the Cross Hall of the White House, April 30, 2025.

PHOTO: THE WHITE HOUSE / MOLLY RILEY · PUBLIC DOMAIN

The turbine bet

SoftBank reserved well over 13 gigawatts of gas turbines for US data-center power plants, largely from GE Vernova between late 2025 and early 2026, the Journal reported. Even after fully supplying the 9.2-gigawatt gas plant it is to build and run in southern Ohio for an 8-gigawatt data center leased to OpenAI, it held far more than it could use, so as payments loomed it cancelled the excess and unwound some contracts. That produced the $3.7 billion charge in Tuesday's earnings: $2.85

billion of non-refundable advances and $0.88 billion of contract changes and settlements, Dealroom reported.

On November 6 Musk had written on X that "SoftBank is defaulting on their turbine orders." Chief financial officer Yoshimitsu Goto answered: "This is simply not correct at all. There is no such default." GE Vernova said there was "no negative or positive impact" from SoftBank's moves. SoftBank's shares have fallen more than 55% since June, erasing over $160 billion in market value, OfficeChai reported, citing the Journal; Goto said the company must now "balance between gas and brake."

Cybercab and the size of the market

At 8:08 p.m. EST Tuesday Tesla investor Herbert Ong (@herbertong) argued that "Cybercab's ceiling may be set by how much people are willing to travel, not by the size of today's rideshare market." Citing investor Jo Bhakdi (@JOBhakdi), he wrote that valuing Tesla against Uber's market cap is "backwards": "The real comparison is the entire cost of moving people and goods, and that number grows every time the price per mile falls." Musk replied "Yup" at 4:12 a.m. EST Wednesday, a day after writing that "Cybercab will do a majority of all passenger miles in any jurisdiction where it is not prohibited by law."

III · CODE & AI

"C is what you use for optimal performance on bare metal"

A day after saying xAI rewrote its Grok stack in C and C++, Musk defended the choice against Rust fans, and Vercel's chief executive answered that agents will make every language fair game.

The argument began Tuesday morning, when Musk answered a user who asked why the new stack was not written in Rust with "Real men manage their own memory." At 1:20 p.m. EST Tuesday he followed up:

> *"So easy to trigger Rust programmers. Rust is a good language, but C is what you use for optimal performance on bare metal. With great power comes great responsibility."*
>
> ELON MUSK · 1:20 P.M. EST TUESDAY (EMOJI OMITTED)

Grok explains the trade

In a thread replying to Farzad Mesbahi (@farzyness), Grok weighed JAX and SGLang, the tools xAI dropped, citing SGLang's "Python scheduling overhead." When the user summed up that xAI was "exchanging pain and suffering of not having high level language, for absolute speed and precision," Grok answered: "High-level tools like JAX and SGLang speed development and hide memory management, but their overhead costs throughput at this scale. The C/C++ rewrite trades that comfort for direct hardware control, zero interpreter tax, and tighter optimization of every cycle in RL and inference." Musk replied "Yeah" at 1:10 p.m. EST Tuesday.

Guillermo Rauch: "No more one-size-fits-all"

Quoting Musk's Rust post at 9:06 p.m. EST Tuesday, Guillermo Rauch, chief executive of Vercel, wrote: "Rust is a superb language and ecosystem, especially given it was invented pre agentic coding. With agents, new languages will blossom, even purpose-built ones for specific usecases, and discretionary C or even LLVM IR, assembly... AI is fluid. No more one-size-fits-all."

> QUICK HIT
>
> **EU speech rules.** At 12:19 p.m. EST Tuesday Musk reposted a post by the legal group ADF International arguing that the European Union's Digital Services Act (DSA) "threatens freedom of speech GLOBALLY."

Takeaways

1. Singulus will supply SpaceX heterojunction solar-cell lines for Starmind AI satellites, the first in the first half of 2027.
2. Starlink Mini 2 adds a swappable battery good for up to 4.5 hours; invite-only US preorders are open.
3. SoftBank took a $3.7 billion charge on surplus gas turbines; Musk said Masayoshi Son chose WeWork over $12 billion for a quarter of Tesla.
4. Musk defended C over Rust for bare-metal performance.

Sources

Posts by @elonmusk, @SpaceX, @Starlink, @beffjezos, @WSJbusiness, @KatieMiller, @herbertong, @grok, @TinTheTip, @rauchg and @ADFIntl.

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